An exhibition of sports with a difference

Staff Reporter

- About 300 differently-abled people participate in the meet
- Players can spin around quickly in ultra-modern wheelchairs

VISAKHAPATNAM: The one-day international event on wheelchair sports and games organised by the 'Ability People', an NGO engaged in capacity building of the differently-abled, was formally inaugurated by DIG of Police, Visakhapatnam Range Soumya Mishra on Sunday.

About 300 people with diverse disabilities including hearing and speech impaired and differently-abled participated in the coaching, training and demonstration programme aimed at enabling them to participate in wheelchair sports and games. The one-day programme is basically to instil confidence in them.

The twice football world champion Peter of Basketball Association of Arizona, USA, who is himself physically challenged, was invited to train and coach the participants in the wheelchair sports and games. Peter, an expert in the field extended training in playing techniques and operation of the specially designed imported wheelchairs. The players can spin around fast in any direction in tune with the game techniques.

Dr. Soumya Mishra watched with interest even as the coach and trainer from US demonstrated the effective use of ultra-modern wheelchairs. She lauded the 'Ability People' and its founder Dileep Patro for undertaking such an interesting exercise with the objective of building confidence in people with different disabilities.

A first-of-its-kind

Mr. Patro said that the event is the first of the kind in the country and involved extension of training and coaching in basketball, tennis, soccer and rugby.

Michael J. Rosenkrantz of National Trust, Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment who participated as capacity builder, said that the National Trust for the welfare of persons with autism, cerebral palsy, mental retardation and multiple disabilities came into being by an act of Parliament as per the U.N. Convention on Disabilities for which India was a signatory.

The Trust deals with multiple issues including welfare, housing, health, life insurance and training of the disabled. The mandate is to showcase abilities of the disabled people and discover abilities in them. The Trust works with 900 NGOs championing the cause of the differently-abled.

HPCL Senior Manager K.V.S.R. Raju, Port Trust deputy CAO G.S.S. Kumar and Samaikya Bharathi presiden Vani Prabhakar were present Participants hailed from sev eral coastal districts o Andhra.



HAVING A BALL: *Differently-abled people playing basketball on wheelchairs in the city on Sunday.*

sioners oppose commendations

"Union Labour

not at all justified.

Besides, Rs.25,000 must

READER'S MAIL

Rice prasadam

visited Andhra University in 1954' recently in *The Hindu*

that others could not keep pace with him!

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